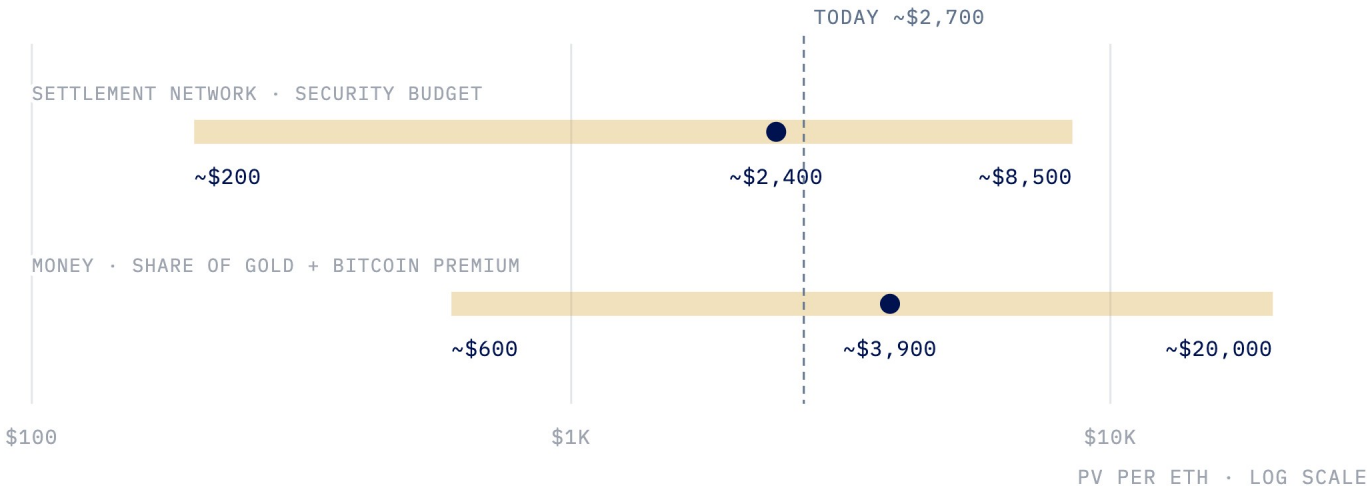


ETH’s price isn’t a claim on fees. It’s a bet on what the network secures.

Ethereum is built to keep fees low, and its fees support only a small fraction of ETH’s ~\$2,700 price. The value sits in the network: ETH as the asset that secures onchain finance, and ETH as money. Read through a security-budget rule, today’s price needs Ethereum to secure roughly \$2.3T by 2035, about twelve times today’s ~\$186B. On the forecasters’ own numbers, tokenization gets there by 2030; the forecasters have overshot before.

01 · TWO WAYS TO VALUE THE NETWORK

Present value per ETH, bear to bull, against today’s price. The bar spans the scenarios; the dot marks the base case.



Both base cases bracket today’s price, and the spreads are wide. One lens asks how large ETH must be to secure what’s built on it; the other, what share of the gold and Bitcoin premium it takes. They price the same demand two ways and don’t add.

~9%	~2%	~\$2.4–4.6T	~30% a year	~\$2.3T
OF TODAY’S PRICE THAT FEES SUPPORT, EVEN WITH AGENTIC GROWTH (BASE CASE)	OF THE GOLD + BITCOIN PREMIUM IMPLIED BY 2035	FORECAST-IMPLIED ON ETHEREUM BY 2030	GROWTH IN SECURED VALUE THAT TODAY’S PRICE REQUIRES	SECURED ON ETHEREUM BY 2035 TO JUSTIFY TODAY’S PRICE

Fees still matter to the system: they’re ETH’s only burn, and a larger share of the security budget if issuance falls. They just aren’t what justifies the price. That rests on the network securing trillions, and whether it does is the whole trade.

ETH at ~\$2,700 (30 Sep 2026). Present value at 10%, 3% terminal growth, horizon end-2035, base supply ~130M ETH (~122M today). Settlement lens: $\frac{1}{3} \times \text{staking ratio} \times \text{market cap} \geq \text{margin} \times \text{extractable share} \times \text{value secured}$, base staking ratio ~40%; share at risk ~2% bear, ~5% base and bull (more tokenized value means more issuer-controlled value); a minimum size for secure settlement, not a forecast. Value secured is stablecoins plus tokenized assets on Ethereum (~\$186B today), excluding DeFi TVL. Money lens: gold at 90% monetary (Etherealize’s convention) plus Bitcoin, ~\$28T today, grown ~4% a year. Fee share: L1 fees in 2035 from Chalom’s ~\$4T revenue pool (~15% onchain after ~25% fee compression, ~55% on Ethereum, ~2% L1 take), capitalized at $1/(r - g)$, ~\$230 per ETH in present value. Forecasts are global; Ethereum-implied figures apply today’s ~62% stablecoin share. Lenses are alternatives, not additive. Sources: Token Terminal; ethereum.org; P2P.org; World Gold Council; CoinGecko; Coinbase; McKinsey (Jun 2024); Citi GPS (Jun 2026). Framework draws on Etherealize, “Ethereum and the Era of Productive Money” (Apr 2026); Vitalik Buterin, “The cryptographic world computer” (Sep 2026); and Joseph Chalom (Sep 2026), CEO and a director of SharpLink (SBET). Not affiliated with Etherealize or SharpLink. The author holds SBET shares.

02 · WHAT THE SETTLEMENT LENS NEEDS

PV per ETH by value secured on Ethereum in 2035 and by the share of it at risk from an attack.

SECURED, 2035	2%	5% · BASE	10%	
~\$0.5T	~\$240	~\$600	~\$1,200	
~\$1T	~\$480	~\$1,200	~\$2,400	
~\$2T	~\$950	~\$2,400	~\$4,800	
~\$3T	~\$1,400	~\$3,600	~\$7,200	FORECAST BAND · 2030
~\$4T	~\$1,900	~\$4,800	~\$9,500	
~\$6T	~\$2,900	~\$7,200	~\$14,000	

COLUMNS: SHARE OF SECURED VALUE AT RISK, INCL. SAFETY MARGIN · SHADED = AT OR ABOVE ~\$2,700

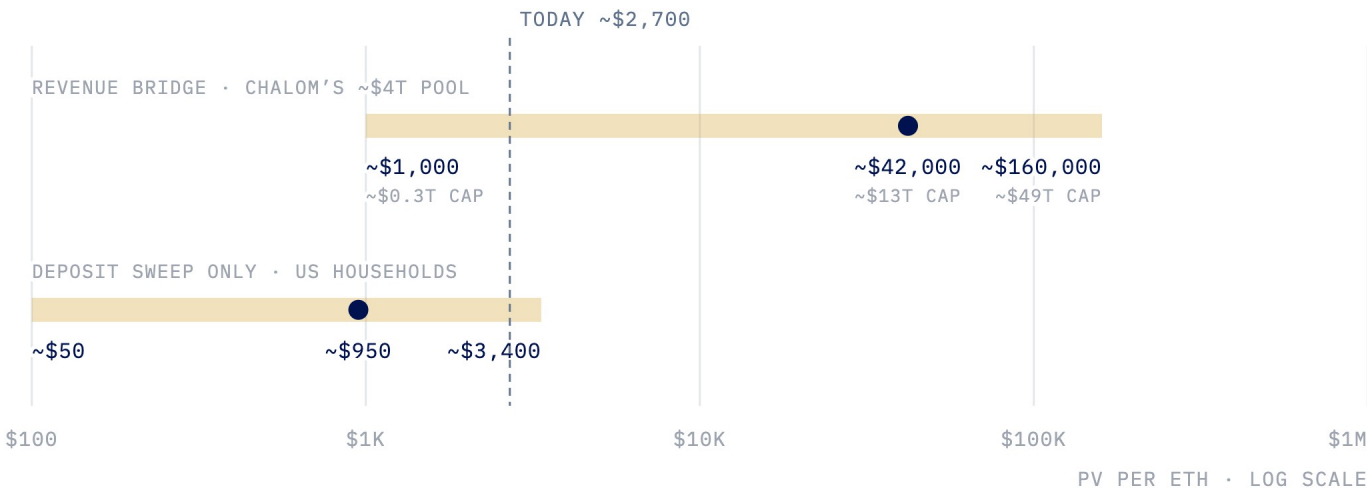
Stablecoins and tokenized funds can be frozen and reissued by their issuers, so little is extractable. At 5% at risk the price needs ~\$2.3T secured; at 2%, roughly \$5.7T; today’s price implies ~20%. For context, McKinsey expects ~\$2T and Citi ~\$5.5T in tokenized assets by 2030, plus ~\$1.9T in stablecoins (Citi): ~\$2.4–4.6T on Ethereum at today’s ~62% share. Citi puts today’s tokenized market at ~\$17B.

ETH’s price needs ~0.5% of agentic finance’s balances on Ethereum. The assets have to follow.

SharpLink’s CEO puts the financial-services revenue AI agents put up for grabs at ~\$4T a year by 2035. Banks earn about 1% a year on the balances they intermediate, so that revenue implies ~\$425T of balances behind it. If ~8% of those sat on Ethereum, the security-budget rule would put ETH near ~\$42,000 in today’s money, with a market cap near ~\$13T in 2035, about a third of the ~\$40T we assume for the gold-plus-Bitcoin premium then. Today’s price needs ~0.5%.

01 · FROM AGENT REVENUE TO VALUE PER ETH

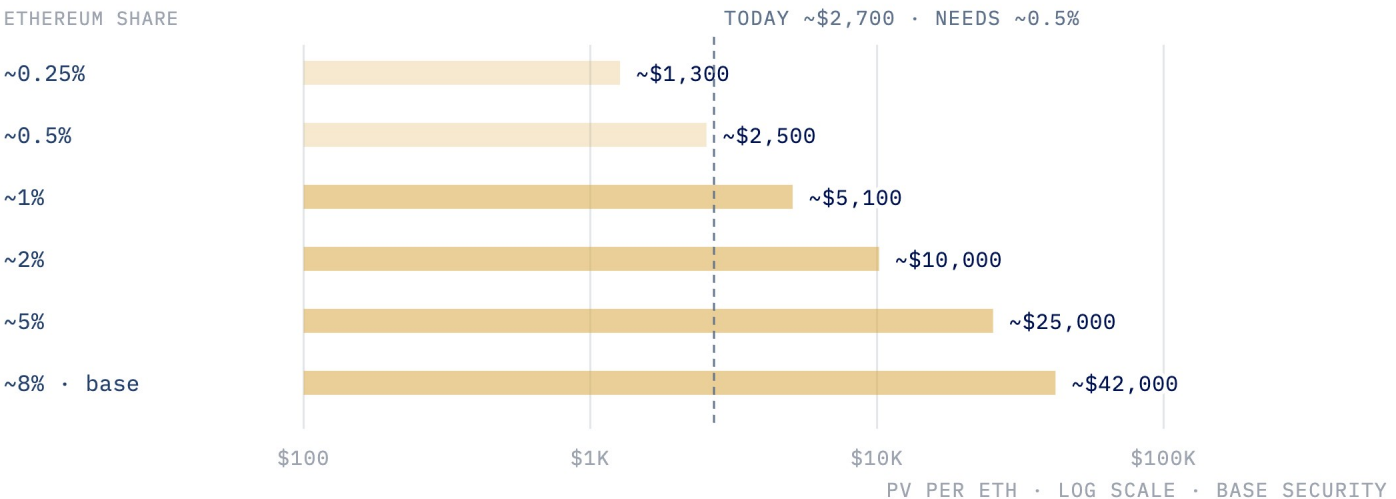
Present value per ETH, bear to bull, with the market cap each case needs in 2035. Same security rule and log scale as the first slide.



The revenue bridge clears today’s price many times over in its base case; the market caps beside it show why the base and bull cases are conditional. The deposit sweep, agents moving idle US cash into onchain funds, is the one channel Chalom spells out, and it reaches today’s price only in its bull case.

02 · WHERE THE CHAIN CAN BREAK

PV per ETH by Ethereum’s share of the ~\$425T of balances implied in the base case, holding base security assumptions.



Agents can redirect the revenue without the assets moving: an agent can switch your money-market fund without that fund living on Ethereum. The share that does move onchain is the assumption to watch; today’s price needs about half a percent.

~\$425T BALANCES IMPLIED BY ~\$4T OF REVENUE AT A ~1% MARGIN	~15× BASE-CASE VALUE SECURED VS. WHAT TODAY’S PRICE REQUIRES	~\$42,000 BASE-CASE PV PER ETH · NEEDS A ~\$13T MARKET CAP IN 2035	~\$14.5T US HOUSEHOLD DEPOSITS, THE POOL AGENTS WOULD SWEEP	~0.5% OF IMPLIED BALANCES ON ETHEREUM TO JUSTIFY TODAY’S PRICE
--	--	--	---	--

Watch how much of those balances actually tokenizes, not agent counts or payment volumes. That is where this case is won or lost.

ETH at ~\$2,700 (30 Sep 2026). Revenue pool: Chalom (Sep 2026), ~\$4T a year up for grabs by 2035; his fee universe is narrower than McKinsey’s \$7.3T of 2025 banking revenue. Revenue margin: McKinsey Global Banking Annual Review 2026, revenues after risk costs ~0.94% of \$406T in deposits, loans and AUM (2025); bear ~1.6% before risk costs, bull ~0.8%. McKinsey’s balances count deposits and the loans they fund, so implied balances overstate distinct assets; a smaller base would raise the ~0.5% needed. Onchain (~5/15/35%) and Ethereum (~40/55/65%, L1 and L2) shares as on the first slide, whose value secured is L1 only, a modest overstatement; implied balances stay below global financial assets (~\$500T at end-2024, FSB) grown ~6% a year. Deposit sweep: US household deposits ~\$14.5T (Federal Reserve Z.1, end-2025) × 2/10/25% swept onchain × Ethereum share. Security rule, 10% discount rate, end-2035 horizon, supply, and the gold + Bitcoin premium (~\$28T today, grown ~4% a year) as on the first slide; bear uses its own security assumptions, which is why it falls below today’s price; bull holds base share at risk. Not additive with the first slide’s value secured, which describes overlapping assets. Chalom is CEO and a director of SharpLink (SBET). Not affiliated with Etherealize or SharpLink. The author holds SBET shares.